

First Read

Taiyo Yuden

Key takeaways from small sell-side meeting

Discussions focused on AI domain

On 21 May, we joined a small meeting attended by Katsuya Sase, company president, and sell-side analysts. Discussions highlighted expansion in business opportunities for MLCCs for AI servers and expectations for miniaturisation and higher capacity. However, based on Taiyo Yuden's assumptions and results, we caution that AI-related growth rates are likely to trail those of the industry's largest players. We think attention should be paid to growth in business opportunities accompanying the launch of new products from H2 FY3/27.

Growth in small, high-capacity ASIC MLCCs expected from H2 FY3/27

In FY3/26, the ratio of servers within consolidated sales was 6-7% (around 9% for MLCCs). AI appears to have accounted for roughly half of this. Taiyo Yuden plans for AI-related sales growth to accelerate from +30% yoy in FY3/26 to +80% in FY3/27. The company plans to expand sales of new small, high-capacity MLCC products (1005 size/47µF, 1608 size/100µF) for AI ASIC applications from H2 FY3/27. It was emphasised that multi-layer stacking and materials technology are critical for stacking ceramic sheets of less than 1µm. In automotives, the previously gradual downsizing trend is now becoming more pronounced in the AI domain. Although focus is on Taiyo Yuden's growth in the high-end smartphone segment, where it has a proven track record, it seems it will be necessary to closely monitor the competitive environment with leading companies that excel in small, high-capacity products.

Price pressure is easing, but...

MLCCs and inductors are likely to see price increases for some products due to higher costs stemming from rising raw material prices. However, Taiyo Yuden explained that price increases driven by supply-demand factors are not currently planned. Regarding MLCC capacity expansion, the company said that it intends to proceed at a normal pace of +10%/year, reflecting on the slight over-investment during the previous medium-term plan.

Growth in sales of multi-layer metal inductors for AI ASIC applications likely to begin in H2 FY3/28 and accelerate in FY3/29

AI servers currently use large wire-wound inductors, which has prevented Taiyo Yuden, specialising in compact components, from entering the market. In IVR (integrated voltage regulator), which contributes to improvements in the energy efficiency and performance of AI GPUs/ASICs, power management functions (PMICs) are placed near the processor. IVR requires embedding passive components within the substrate, necessitating miniaturisation. The company expressed its intention to expand sales of its proprietary stacked metal inductors for IVR applications.

Valuation: Neutral rating, price target ¥4,100

We base our price target on an FY3/27E PER of 21X.

Equities

Japan

Electric Components & Equipment

12-month rating **Neutral**

12m price target **¥4,100**

Price (21 May 2026) **¥8,145**

RIC: 6976.T BBG: 6976 JP

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range	¥8,145-2,268
Market cap.	¥1,019b/US\$6.40b
Shares o/s	125m (ORD)
Free float	56%
Avg. daily volume ('000)	3,434
Avg. daily value (m)	¥19,312.6
Common s/h equity (03/26E)	¥322b
P/BV (03/26E)	3.2x
Net debt to EBITDA (03/26E)	1.3x

EPS (reported, basic) (¥)

	UBS	Cons.
03/26E	114.0	118.5
03/27E	197.0	190.9
03/28E	251.0	269.7

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Highlights (¥b)	03/23	03/24	03/25	03/26E	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E
Revenues	319.5	322.6	341.4	359.6	389.5	414.7	441.8	467.6
Operating profit	32.0	9.1	10.5	18.5	32.5	41.6	51.5	60.4
Recurring profit	34.8	13.8	10.5	19.2	33.2	42.3	52.2	61.1
Net profit (reported)	23.2	8.3	2.3	14.2	24.6	31.3	38.6	45.2
EPS (reported, basic) (¥)	186.3	66.7	18.7	114.0	197.0	251.0	309.7	362.5
Profitability/valuation	03/23	03/24	03/25	03/26E	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	10.0	2.8	3.1	5.1	8.3	10.0	11.7	12.9
ROIC (EBIT) %	10.5	2.6	2.7	4.5	7.7	9.6	11.6	13.3
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	8.3	10.6	8.0	16.7	13.7	12.2	10.9	9.8
P/E (reported, basic) x	24.1	58.5	>100	71.5	41.4	32.5	26.3	22.5
Dividend yield (net) %	2.0	2.3	2.9	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of ¥8,145 on 21-May-2026

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	-49.7%
Forecast dividend yield	1.1%
Forecast stock return	-48.6%
Market return assumption	7.8%
Forecast excess return	-56.3%

Company Description

Taiyo Yuden was established in 1950 by Hikohachi Sato, who had worked on the development, commercialization, and mass production of titanium oxide ceramic capacitors. We estimate Taiyo Yuden's current market share at around 15%, making it a major maker of passive devices and No.3 in the MLCC industry. The company is strong especially in production of high-capacity MLCCs. Taiyo Yuden also makes coils and other ferrites as well as SAW/FBAR devices.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Our price target is based on PER. Risks include: 1) weaker-than-expected demand for the company's main products because of a slowdown in US economic growth or for other reasons; 2) unfavourable trends in the US stock market; 3) rapid exchange rate fluctuations; 4) diffusion and commoditization of important technologies because of personnel losses (in the high-capacity ceramic capacitor market, for example); 5) a decline in the importance of ceramic capacitors because of improvements in other types of capacitors or because of advances in the semiconductor industry; and 6) oversupply of DVD media and substantially lower prices.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Taiyo Yuden

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	2
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	4
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	N/A
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	N/A
7. What's driving the difference?	
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	No Catalyst
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	N/A
11. What is the catalyst?	

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Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	54%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Taiyo Yuden ²⁸	6976.T	Neutral	¥8,145	21 May 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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Taiyo Yuden (¥)



Date	Stock Price (¥)	Price Target (¥)	Rating
2023-02-21	4150	6200	Buy
2023-05-10	4050	5600	Buy
2023-08-04	4113	5200	Buy
2023-11-08	3798	4800	Buy
2024-03-29	3625	4350	Buy
2024-07-02	4105	4750	Buy
2024-11-14	2208	2200	Neutral
2025-06-18	2359	2400	Neutral
2025-10-29	4216	4100	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 21-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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